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Functional Skills Level 2 English Writing Sample Paper 1

Worked Example – good pass

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- Assessment: Sample Paper 1 (Exemplar Benchmarks: Good · Borderline · Fail)
- Subject: City & Guilds Functional Skills English Level 2 Writing (4748)
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Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Good pass

Question 1

You have recently been on two different work placements.

- You were given the first placement but you found it to be quite boring and irrelevant to your future career path.
- You chose the second one yourself and found it much more interesting and beneficial because it was more relevant to your career plans.

Your task: write a blog about your experiences aimed at people preparing for work experience. Your blog should encourage people to seek their own work placements in an area that interests them and explain how it will benefit their career development.

(27 marks)

Write around 5 to 8 paragraphs.

Work Placements – How to make the most of them

I was at the stage in college where I had to find a work placement. Like many students I didn't really know how to go about it so I did nothing. The college found me my placement instead. Great – you might think! Well it wasn't. Because I couldn't be bothered to find a placement the one they found for me turned out to be totally irrelavant to my chosen career path. I plan to own my own catering company one day but the placement they gave me was in an office doing filling and photocopying. I guess the only think it taught me was that I definately do not want to work in an office! I stayed there a week all the time wishing I had found my own placement.

As soon as I left that placement I started to look for another one by doing a simple search on the internet for local catering companys. After about 10 minuets I had a list of 15 companys I could approach. I updated my CV (it's got to be done!) wrote a covring letter and sent it to all 15 companys. I recieved a reply off 4 or them and one placement offer. I jumped at the chance.

What was it like? It was fantasic. I helped find new customers, I visited customers to discuss menus, I designed table layouts, I booked venus, I helped prepare food, I waited on tables, I helped

with accounts and yes, I did some filling! But at least it was for a company I cared about.

There is no doubt that this placement has helped me in lots of ways and the right placement would really help you. Don't rely on others to do the work for you. Go out and find your own placement in a business that interests you. Not only will it teach you about the business it will help you firm up your opinions and you never know they might even offer you a job. Go for it!

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing	✓				
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion	✓				
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose	✓				
Constructs complex sentences	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						24

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Good pass

Commentary

The candidate was asked to write a blog. The presence of the title shows the candidate understands this convention of a blog, and the paragraphing is used effectively. The language choices are suitable for the audience and the purpose and all the information, ideas and opinions are clearly and coherently communicated in sufficient detail.

Spelling is correct most of the time, and any errors do not impede meaning.
The candidate has omitted many commas that should have been used to separate clauses. Sentence demarcation is strong, there is some evidence of comma use to separate items in a list and apostrophes have been used to denote contractions. Grammar is very strong throughout.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Good pass

Question 2

It is well known that celebrities use the media to help their careers, but they don't seem to like it when the media covers their private lives.

- Is it right how the media treats celebrities?
- How do celebrities benefit from the media and how does the media benefit from celebrities?
- Should anything be off-limits or can the media cover everything about celebrities and their private lives?

Your task: Write an article for a student magazine exploring the extent to which it is fair that the private lives of celebrities are covered in the media.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

Celebrities and the media

We've all seen the picutes of celebreties in the media standing on the red carpet at a film premiur or poseing for photographers outside an award ceremony. And we've also seen those pictures of celebrities taken by photographers with long distance lenses as they snap them relaxing in their own time not even knowing they are being photographed. Are both types of photo acceptable? Is it fair that celebrities private lives are photographed? Lets get one thing straight. Celebrities would not be so famous if it wasn't for the media. If they were not as famouse they wouldn't earn as much money. Especially those celebrities who are famous for simply being themselfs, and not for any special talent. Therefore you could argue that the media should be able to get something back from the celebrities. After all, they help to keep the person famous. So perhaps those photos of their private lives when they do not look so glamourus are ok. On the other hand the media also gets something out of the celebrities because it is us the consumers who buy the magazines, log on to the websites and watch the showbiz news. The more we do that the more the medai makes money trough advertising. So they use each other. Should anything be of limits for photographers? Probably. Private lives are just that – private. But if the photographers are not braking any laws then in the eyes of the

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Good pass

law they can take any photos they want. As they get paid huge amounts for shots of celebrities I can't see this changing any time soon. It's hard to ask a photographer not to earn as much money by not taking a shot especially when they know another photographer will do it anyway.

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing			✓		
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion	✓				
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose	✓				
Constructs complex sentences		✓			
Overall band	Band 4				13
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						22

Overall mark for question 1	24
Overall mark for question 2	22
FINAL MARK	46

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Good pass

Commentary

The composition elements are strong, with the exception of paragraphing. Language and register are appropriate to the task and the detail is well covered. Meaning is conveyed clearly through the use of varied sentence structures, and coherence is established and maintained throughout.

Punctuation is accurate only some of the time. Sentence demarcation is secure, but the use of other punctuation marks is limited. Spelling is accurate most of the time and grammar is consistently strong.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

Question 1

You have recently been on two different work placements.

- You were given the first placement but you found it to be quite boring and irrelevant to your future career path.
- You chose the second one yourself and found it much more interesting and beneficial because it was more relevant to your career plans.

Your task: write a blog about your experiences aimed at people preparing for work experience. Your blog should encourage people to seek their own work placements in an area that interests them and explain how it will benefit their career development.

(27 marks)

Write around 5 to 8 paragraphs.

Work Placements

I have recently been on two work placement s and I thought I would share my experiances with you my readers. In my opion work placements are an inportant part of learning and any student should think about them.

My first placement

My first one wasn't very good, my experiance was that they wasn't very helpfull towards my furture career. Part of the problem was that i relyed on someone else finding the placement for me and what I should of done is found it my self. I have always wanted to work in the fashion industry, but my placement was in a company that sell water filters! I lasted two days and left because I new it was not for me.

My second placement

My second placement I made sure it was much better because I found it my self by looking on the internet. I worked in a model agency called bright life and they help me do all sorts of things that I enjoyed.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

Always find your own placement then you know it will be useful and what you want to do.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing	✓				
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion		✓			
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose		✓			
Constructs complex sentences		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				10
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation			2			
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						7
SPaG mark + composition mark						17

Commentary

There has been a good attempt to address the question brief, and there is also evidence that language has been adapted to suit the audience. Format and structure are strong, with the tile, subheadings and paragraphing all contributing to the coherence and the clear and effective communication of information, ideas and opinions. Detail was lacking in some areas and the length is relatively short.

Punctuation is correct only some of the time, although sentence demarcation is generally secure. There is evidence of the correct use of apostrophes for contractions and one

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

instance of the correct comma to separate clauses. Spelling errors are numerous and include relatively simple words. Grammar is generally sound although there are errors of verb-tense agreement and inconsistent tense selection.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

Question 2

It is well known that celebrities use the media to help their careers, but they don't seem to like it when the media covers their private lives.

- Is it right how the media treats celebrities?
- How do celebrities benefit from the media and how does the media benefit from celebrities?
- Should anything be off-limits or can the media cover everything about celebrities and their private lives?

Your task: Write an article for a student magazine exploring the extent to which it is fair that the private lives of celebrities are covered in the media.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

Media and famous people

We all like reading news about pop stars and seeing pictures of are favorite actors and celebs and I know that when it suits them celebs love been talked about and photographed so is there a time when it is not right that they can be photographed and talked about?

If the media didn't cover celebs so much they would not be as famous, so they definately need them. But what if they invade there space to much or turn against them. Then it can get nasty and people get hurt and upset. Some media can distroy a peresons carer and make the public turn against them. Is that right. I'm not sure. But if that person has done some thing wrong and they should of resind from there job then it is ok if the media cover there story because they shouldn't of doen the wrong thing in the first place. But if they have done nothing wrong and the media just keeps covering them even when they are at home doing there own thing then it is wrong and the media should not do it.

Also, the media need the famous people too because they helps them sell all there newspapers and magazines so they should know better and treat them with respect not invade their privacy all the time.

I hope you have enjoyed my article

Kind regards

Sian T

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing		✓			
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion			✓		
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose			✓		
Constructs complex sentences			✓		
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	9

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation			2			
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						7
SPaG mark + composition mark						16

Overall mark for question 1	17
Overall mark for question 2	16
FINAL MARK	33

Commentary

Most detail has been covered, but there could have been more expansion upon the benefits received by the media, as suggested in the question brief. The format and structure are generally good until the end, where the candidate becomes slightly confused and appears to turn it into a letter/email through the use of *Kind regards*. The language is relatively simple, and the lack of punctuation enhances this perception. There is ambiguity in some of the sentences, which impacts upon the effectiveness of the writing as a whole.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline

There are several spelling errors, some on relatively simple words, and the vocabulary choice is not particularly ambitious. Punctuation errors are frequent, especially in omitting commas to separate clauses and when possessive apostrophes should have been used. Grammar is generally correct although there are errors.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Fail

Question 1

You have recently been on two different work placements.

- You were given the first placement but you found it to be quite boring and irrelevant to your future career path.
- You chose the second one yourself and found it much more interesting and beneficial because it was more relevant to your career plans.

Your task: write a blog about your experiences aimed at people preparing for work experience. Your blog should encourage people to seek their own work placements in an area that interests them and explain how it will benefit their career development.

(27 marks)

Write around 5 to 8 paragraphs.

I went on a work placenent. It was gived to me by a collage. It was nothin to do with my corse. I have been working in a charity shop cleaning cloths and helping poelpe. My corse is brickwork. It was waste of time and I should never of being given it. 2nd one was better cos I was on site working with an old fella who has being laying bricks all is life. He was descent bloke and tort me stuff all about different bonds andother teknikes. dont do one that is rubbish do one that is good for your carer. I learned good stuff with him.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing				✓	
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion			✓		
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose			✓		
Constructs complex sentences				✓	
Overall band	Band 2				5
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Fail

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						3
SPaG mark + composition mark						8

Commentary

The instruction is to write 5 to 8 paragraphs. This has clearly not been followed as the candidate has written only one paragraph of approximately 100 words. Whilst there has been an attempt to write about the task, the level of detail is sparse and does not fully address all the elements in the question. The lack of detail and brevity affect the overall coherence, cohesion and effectiveness of the communication as a whole. A title would have enhanced the format and structure marks, but as it stands, there is nothing to indicate that this is a blog.

Punctuation is limited to some correct sentence demarcation, but some full stops, commas and apostrophes have been omitted. Grammar and spelling are also relatively weak.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Fail

Question 2

It is well known that celebrities use the media to help their careers, but they don't seem to like it when the media covers their private lives.

- Is it right how the media treats celebrities?
- How do celebrities benefit from the media and how does the media benefit from celebrities?
- Should anything be off-limits or can the media cover everything about celebrities and their private lives?

Your task: Write an article for a student magazine exploring the extent to which it is fair that the private lives of celebrities are covered in the media.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

They use the media to make them famous but cant take it when the media photograph them. I think they should of not use the media if they dont wont to be phtoed. I dont think I will like it if they was alwayse taking my photo but if I were famous then I would like it because I will be in the new papers and magazines and every body will read about me making me more famous. Kim Kardashian is alwayse photoed and she is rich and all her family is rich to. David Beckham is famous and is photoed but he dosent always like it if they is taken photos off his kids so it can work both ways. The media shouldnt take the pphotos of them if they dont want them to but they can take photos if they are out and about. If they have to clime over a hedghe or fence it is wrong and if they have to hide any where it is wrong but if they are walking along and then they can take a photo of a clebity.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Fail

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing				✓	
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion				✓	
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose			✓		
Constructs complex sentences			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				5
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						3
SPaG mark + composition mark						8

Overall mark for question 1	8
Overall mark for question 2	8
FINAL MARK	16

Commentary

Once again, the lack of any formatting and paragraphing affects the overall effectiveness of the response. Coherence is not very well established due to a lack of a title and an abrupt opening that does not inform the reader who or what is being written about, and very few devices to give the text cohesion. There are also clarity issues at times and language and register are no wholly appropriate.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 2 Worked Example – Fail

Spelling, punctuation and grammar are poor throughout. Tense selection is inconsistent, and subject-verb agreement and verb-tense agreement are not always accurate. Spelling errors are frequent and suggest a lack of proof-reading, and punctuation consists of some sentence demarcation.

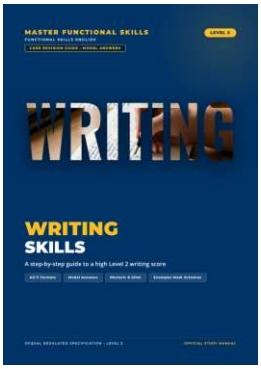
Overall, the standard is well below what is expected for a level 2 candidate.

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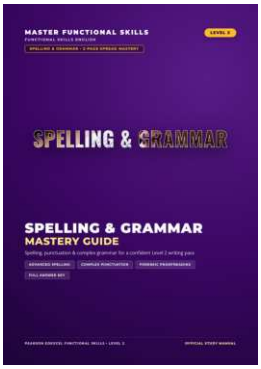


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